

12 ESSENTIAL PHRASAL VERBS

Phrasal verb = verb + particle (adverb or preposition)

Learn the meaning, then notice how each one is used in a natural sentence.

1. HANG OUT

Definition: to spend time relaxing or socializing with someone

Example: *I usually hang out with my friends at a café on Friday evenings.*

2. FIND OUT

Definition: to discover or learn something, especially information you did not know before

Example: *I called the hotel to find out what time check-in starts.*

3. MESS UP

Definition: to make a mistake or do something incorrectly

Example: *I really messed up the presentation by forgetting the last few slides.*

4. LOOK UP

Definition: to search for information in a book, on a website, or on a device

Example: *I looked up the train times before leaving home.*

5. END UP

Definition: to eventually be in a particular place or situation, often unexpectedly

Example: *We missed the last bus and ended up taking a taxi home.*

6. FIGURE OUT

Definition: to understand something or find a solution to a problem

Example: *It took me a while to figure out how to use the new software.*

7. DEAL WITH

Definition: to take action to handle a problem, situation, or person

Example: *Our manager is dealing with several customer complaints today.*

8. HOLD ON

Definition: to wait for a short time

Example: *Hold on a minute — I just need to send this email.*

9. HURRY UP

Definition: to do something more quickly because there is not much time

Example: *Hurry up! The movie starts in ten minutes.*

10. LOOK INTO

Definition: to investigate or examine something carefully

Example: *The company promised to look into the problem with the payment system.*

11. SET UP

Definition: to arrange, prepare, or establish something so that it is ready to use

Example: *Can you help me set up the projector before the meeting?*

12. PUT AWAY

Definition: to return something to its usual place after using it

Example: *Please put away your dishes when you finish eating.*



PHRASAL VERB PRACTICE

Use the phrasal verbs in context. Pay attention to the meaning and grammar.

1. MATCH THE MEANING

Match each phrasal verb (1–12) with the correct definition (A–L).

1. hang out	A. investigate something	7. deal with	G. arrange or prepare something
2. find out	B. wait for a short time	8. hold on	H. search for information
3. mess up	C. spend time relaxing/socializing	9. hurry up	I. eventually be in a situation
4. look up	D. handle a problem or situation	10. look into	J. do something more quickly
5. end up	E. return something to its place	11. set up	K. understand or solve something
6. figure out	F. make a mistake	12. put away	L. discover information

2. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES

Complete each sentence with a phrasal verb from the box. Use the correct form.

hang out • find out • mess up • look up • end up • figure out • deal with • hold on • hurry up •
look into • set up • put away

1. I don't know the answer, but I'll _____ it _____ online.
2. We need to _____ the meeting room before the clients arrive.
3. I made a mistake in the report, but I'll _____ it.
4. _____ a minute — I'm almost ready.
5. After the party, everyone helped _____ the chairs.
6. She spent the weekend _____ with some old friends.
7. The company will _____ the complaint and contact you soon.
8. We missed the train and _____ taking a taxi.
9. Can you _____ what time the store closes?



10. It took me an hour to _____ how the new system works.
11. Please _____ — we're going to be late!
12. He has a difficult customer to _____ today.

3. CHOOSE THE BEST PHRASAL VERB

Choose the correct answer A, B, or C.

1. I can't understand this app. I need to _____ how it works.
A. figure out B. hang out C. put away
2. We need to _____ the new computer before the presentation.
A. end up B. set up C. hold on
3. Can you _____ the word in an online dictionary?
A. look up B. hurry up C. deal with
4. We were planning to eat at home, but we _____ at a restaurant.
A. found out B. looked into C. ended up
5. _____! The bus is leaving.
A. Hurry up B. Look up C. Put away
6. The manager needs to _____ the customer's complaint.
A. hang out B. deal with C. find out

4. MAKE IT PERSONAL

Write complete sentences about your own life. Try to use at least four different phrasal verbs.

A place where you like to hang out: _____

Something you recently found out: _____

Something you sometimes mess up: _____

Something you need to figure out: _____

Something you need to deal with: _____

Something you would like to set up: _____



ANSWER KEY

1. Match the Meaning

1-C 2-L 3-F 4-H 5-I 6-K 7-D 8-B 9-J 10-A 11-G 12-E

2. Complete the Sentences

1. look up
2. set up
3. mess up
4. Hold on
5. put away
6. hanging out
7. look into
8. ended up
9. find out
10. figure out
11. hurry up
12. deal with

3. Choose the Best Phrasal Verb

1. A 2. B 3. A 4. C 5. A 6. B

